EXHIBITION

Comic Relief

An ongoing exhibition—***Comics in Bengal***—at the Kolkata Centre for Creativity brings to light a century of Bengali comics







Iconic comic book writer and publisher Stan Lee once said, "A picture is worth a thousand words, but a comic is worth a million." Fans and viewers flocking to *Comics in Bengal*, an ongoing exhibition at the Kolkata Centre for Creativity, would agree. The show is being held in collaboration with Comics Culture Collective, a group of comic scholars, bibliophiles, researchers, graphic illustrators and cartoonists who have curated and collated their personal collections and sourced other works from fans to create this unique show.

That this often-dismissed medium, in a regional language, would find centre stage was not something its enthusiasts ever expected. "When I came across a book on comics from Thailand [*The Art of Thai Comics* by Nicolas Verstappen], I had won-

CULTURE SPACE

ART CORNER

TRI, A MULTIDISCIPLINARY ART CENTRE, *IS THE LATEST CULTURAL SPACE TO OPEN IN KOLKATA*

What immediately strikes you as you walk up to TRI, the latest art centre in South Kolkata's Ballygunge area that opened on January 19, is the triangular shape of the 1940s mansion. The name TRI is a nod to the same as well as a punny invitation to visitors to "try" out the art, culture and discourse the space aims to offer, director Madeleine St John points out.

"We aim to make it an accessible space, open to anyone in this city," explains St John. "In addition to display of cultural artwork, TRI [will function] as a multidisciplinary platform that will have a full calendar of cultural programming, workshops, performances, lectures and panels providing a robust engagement with art."

Open To Sky Architects restored the mansion that belonged to the city's industrial Thapar family, keeping the façade intact, while turning the interiors a tasteful white and bringing a glass-walled skylight on the roof. Meanwhile, loud music from a local Saraswati puja celebration echo through the building, making the space an intrinsic part of the city.

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"Our affection for Kolkata has been the driving force towards our mission," says co-founder Natasha Thapar. "We're immensely proud of our accomplishment, transforming the building into an art centre that aspires to become a cornerstone of cultural engagement in Kolkata."